



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

WHY HAS PEACE PROVED SO ELUSIVE IN THE MIDDLE EAST?

*Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945-1995 -
Key Topic 3: Attempts at a solution, 1974-95*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT 3.1: Diplomatic Negotiations: From Shuttle Diplomacy to Camp David, 1974–1979			
L2: KT 3.2: The Palestinian Issue: Lebanon, Sabra & Shatila, and the First Intifada, 1974–1993			
L3: KT 3.3: Attempts at a Solution: From the Oslo Accords to Oslo II, 1988–1995			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT 3.1: Diplomatic Negotiations: From Shuttle Diplomacy to Camp David, 1974–1979

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of the oil crisis and the involvement of the USA and the USSR.
- ☐ Analyze Kissinger, 'shuttle diplomacy' and the reopening of the Suez Canal.
- ☐ Evaluate Sadat's visit to Israel (1977), Begin's visit to Egypt (1977), US President Carter and Camp David (1978) and the Treaty of Washington (1979).

Q1. Why was US President Jimmy Carter's personal mediation indispensable in preventing the Camp David negotiations from collapsing?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

On what Jewish holy day did Egypt and Syria launch their surprise attack in October 1973?

What weapon technology did Egyptian forces use to breach the sand ramparts of the Bar-Lev Line in 1973?

What action taken by Arab oil-producing states (OPEC) during the 1973 war caused a global economic crisis?

Who was the US Secretary of State who pioneered 'shuttle diplomacy' between Middle Eastern capitals in 1974–75?

What was the massive sand fortification line built by Israel along the eastern bank of the Suez Canal after 1967?

Which Israeli general led the armoured counter-crossing of the Suez Canal into Egypt in mid-October 1973?

What United Nations resolution passed on 22 October 1973 brought about a ceasefire in the Yom Kippur War?

Who was Israel's Prime Minister during the Yom Kippur War who faced severe domestic criticism for intelligence failures?

Which superpower enacted a massive military airlift (Operation Nickel Grass) to resupply Israel with tanks and ammunition?

Who succeeded Gamal Abdel Nasser as President of Egypt in September 1970?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

OPEC Shuttle Diplomacy Likud Camp David Accords Treaty of Washington

In the years following the Yom Kippur War, Henry Kissinger utilized exhaustive [.] to mediate initial disengagements like the [.] between Israel and its neighbors. A major political shift occurred in Israel with the election of the right-wing [.] party, led by Menachem Begin. Despite Begin's hardline stance, intense negotiations with Egypt led to the historic [.] in 1978. This framework ultimately resulted in the 1979 [.], marking the first formal peace treaty between Israel and an Arab nation amidst an era of global economic [.] influenced by [.].

Q2. How did the 1973 Yom Kippur War change the diplomatic calculations of the United States?

Q3. What was the result of Henry Kissinger's Sinai II Agreement (September 1975)?

Q4. What dramatic gesture did Anwar Sadat make on 19 November 1977 to break the diplomatic deadlock?

Q5. Source Detective: Explain why control of Sharm ash Shaykh and the Strait of Tiran at the southern tip of Sinai was such a vital strategic issue in the peace treaty.

Q6. Outline the key terms of Framework 2 of the 1978 Camp David Accords.

Q7. What was the tragic personal consequence for Anwar Sadat following the signing of the peace treaty?

Q8. Explain how the 1973 OPEC oil embargo pressured Western powers to pursue peace negotiations in the Middle East.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q9. Why did people hold contrasting views on President Anwar Sadat's decision to sign the 1979 peace treaty with Israel?

Guidance: Contrast the Egyptian perspective (regained the Sinai Peninsula without further casualties) against other Arab nations and Palestinians who felt Sadat signed a separate peace and abandoned the Palestinian cause.

SENTENCE STARTERS:

- Supporters viewed Sadat as a courageous peacemaker because...
- However, many in the Arab world condemned Sadat because...

Pupil Response:



GCSE Exam Practice

Q10. Explain one consequence of the 1979 Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty (Treaty of Washington) for Egypt's position in the Arab world.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 3-STEP PEE FORMULA (POINT, EVIDENCE, EXPLANATION)

EDEXCEL PAPER
2

Write exactly 1 focused analytical paragraph (approx. 5 minutes). Do NOT write an introduction, conclusion, or a second consequence.

[P] Point (Consequence): State ONE clear, valid consequence of the Camp David Accords (1978) and the Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty (1979) directly addressing the geopolitical balance of the Middle East.

[E] Evidence (Contextual Detail): Deploy precise historical facts (names, dates, treaties, or figures) from 1978–1981 to prove what happened.

[E] Explanation (Causal Impact): Explain the lasting causal effect on Arab-Jewish relations or regional geopolitics using causal connectives.

Sentence Starters:

- "One consequence of the 1979 Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty was the total diplomatic and political isolation of Egypt within the Arab world."
- "For example, following the treaty signing on the White House lawn, the Arab League immediately suspended Egypt's membership, moved its headquarters from Cairo to Tunis, and severed diplomatic relations."
- "As a direct result of neutralizing Egypt—historically the largest and most powerful Arab military force—Israel was freed from the strategic nightmare of facing a multi-front war, which consequently provoked fury among radical Islamists and culminated in the assassination of Anwar Sadat in October 1981."

Causal Connectives: As a direct result • Consequently • This led directly to • Because of this • This meant that • Crucially

EXIT TICKET: SPOT THE HISTORICAL IMPOSTER EXIT TICKET • TWO TRUTHS & ONE FALLACY

Identify the IMPOSTER among these three statements regarding the 1982 Lebanon War:

- Statement A: Israeli Defense Minister Ariel Sharon sent troops far beyond the declared 40-kilometer buffer zone to lay siege to Beirut and expel Yasser Arafat's PLO leadership to Tunisia.
- Statement B: The Sabra and Shatila massacres were carried out directly by Israeli soldiers following an explicit order from Prime Minister Menachem Begin.
- Statement C: The official Israeli Kahan Commission found Ariel Sharon bore "personal responsibility" for failing to prevent the massacre, forcing his resignation as Defense Minister.

Teacher Guidance: Task: Identify the false statement (Statement B: the massacre was committed by Christian Phalangist militiamen, though Israeli forces encircled the camps) and write the correction.

Pupil Response:

L2: KT 3.2: The Palestinian Issue: Lebanon, Sabra & Shatila, and the First Intifada, 1974–1993

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand Arafat's speech to the UN (1974) and the significance of PLO activities in Lebanon.
- ☐ Analyze Israeli reprisals, the invasion of Lebanon (1982) and the results.
- ☐ Evaluate the situation in the Israeli occupied territories and the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93).

Q1. Why did the Israeli invasion of Lebanon and the siege of Beirut provoke unprecedented domestic protests and international condemnation?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which Egyptian President stunned the world by flying to Jerusalem to address the Israeli Knesset in November 1977?

Who was the right-wing Likud Prime Minister of Israel who negotiated with Sadat?

What presidential retreat in Maryland hosted 13 days of intense secret negotiations brokered by Jimmy Carter in September 1978?

What was the formal peace treaty signed on the White House lawn between Egypt and Israel on 26 March 1979 called?

What major territory did Israel agree to return entirely to Egyptian sovereignty in exchange for peace and demilitarisation?

How did the Arab League punish Egypt for signing a separate bilateral peace treaty with Israel in 1979?

What tragic event occurred to President Anwar Sadat on 6 October 1981 during a military parade in Cairo?

Who succeeded Anwar Sadat as President of Egypt in October 1981?

What diplomatic method involved Henry Kissinger flying back and forth between Middle Eastern capitals to broker disengagement treaties?

What international maritime waterway did Egypt agree to open to Israeli commercial shipping under the 1979 treaty?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

UN Resolution 3236 Fatahland Operation Peace for Galilee Sabra and Shatila First Intifada Hezbollah
--

Your Sentence:

Q2. What was the significance of UN Resolution 3236 (November 1974) for the PLO?

Q3. What was 'Fatahland' and how did it threaten Israeli security?

Q4. What pretext did Israeli Defense Minister Ariel Sharon use to launch Operation Peace for Galilee in June 1982?

Q5. Source Detective: Study the arrows marking the Israeli advance northward. How does the map demonstrate that Sharon pushed the invasion far beyond the initial 40-kilometre security zone to encircle Beirut?

Q6. What were Ariel Sharon's larger geopolitical ambitions behind the 1982 invasion of Lebanon?

Q7. Describe the events and consequences of the Sabra and Shatila massacre in September 1982.

Q8. What event marked the start of the First Palestinian Intifada in December 1987?

Q9. How did the First Intifada shift global public sympathy toward the Palestinian cause?

Q10. Explain the consequences of the 1982 Israeli siege of Beirut for the PLO leadership.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q11. Explain why international television broadcasts of the First Intifada damaged Israel's reputation across the world.

***Guidance:** Contrast television footage of heavily armed Israeli soldiers using tear gas and live ammunition against Palestinian teenagers and children armed only with stones.*

SENTENCE STARTERS:

- *The First Intifada damaged Israel's global reputation because TV news showed...*
- *This shifted world opinion because, unlike previous wars where Israel was seen as the underdog, Israel was now seen as...*

Pupil Response:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q12. Write a narrative account analysing the escalation of the Israeli-Palestinian conflict in the years 1982–1988. You may use the following in your answer: • Operation Peace for Galilee and the siege of Beirut (1982) • The outbreak of the First Intifada in Gaza (1987) You must also use information of your own.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

**EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 3-STAGE CHRONOLOGICAL LINKAGE CHAIN
(BEGINNING → MIDDLE → END)**

EDEXCEL
PAPER 2

Write exactly 3 logically connected chronological paragraphs (approx. 10–12 minutes). You **MUST** use both stimulus points **PLUS** at least one development from your own knowledge. Show **HOW** each event directly triggered the next.

[1] The Beginning (Catalyst & Origin): Explain how cross-border fedayeen raids provoked Israel's full-scale invasion of Lebanon in June 1982 ('Operation Peace for Galilee') (Stimulus: 1982 Lebanon invasion).

[2] The Middle (Causal Turning Point): Explain the decisive turning point of the siege of Beirut, the expulsion of the PLO leadership to Tunisia, and the international outcry over the Sabra and Shatila massacres (Own Knowledge).

[3] The End (Culmination & Resolution): Explain the culmination: the explosion of the grassroots First Intifada in December 1987 in Gaza and the West Bank, which forced both Israel and the PLO to reconsider diplomacy (Stimulus; First Intifada 1987).

Sentence Starters:

- *"The crisis was initiated in June 1982 when Israeli Defence Minister Ariel Sharon launched 'Operation Peace for Galilee', sending 76,000 troops across the border to destroy PLO bases in southern Lebanon and drive all the way to Beirut."*
- *"A decisive turning point occurred in September 1982 following the expulsion of Arafat and 14,000 PLO fighters to Tunisia, when Lebanese Christian Phalangist militias massacred between 800 and 3,500 Palestinian civilians in the Sabra and Shatila refugee camps while the IDF surrounded the perimeter, provoking immense international condemnation."*
- *"This protracted displacement culminated in December 1987 when spontaneous grassroots frustration exploded into the First Intifada in Gaza and the West Bank, where unarmed youths confronting armed soldiers with stones shattered Israel's international standing and created the urgent political necessity for the Oslo peace talks."*

Causal Connectives: The crisis was initiated when • This directly triggered • A decisive turning point occurred when • Consequently • As a direct consequence • This situation culminated in

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Stimulus Point 1

Operation Peace for Galilee and the siege of Beirut (1982)

Stimulus Point 2

The outbreak of the First Intifada in Gaza (1987)

EXIT TICKET: THE CAUSAL BALANCE SCALE

EXIT TICKET · THE CAUSAL BALANCE SCALE

Weigh the driving leadership of the First Intifada on a scale of 0 to 10:

- [0] 100% Spontaneous Grassroots Rebellion: Driven entirely by frustrated youth in Gaza and the West Bank throwing stones.
 - [5] A Blend: Began spontaneously, but was quickly steered by local clandestine committees (UNLU).
 - [10] 100% Orchestrated by Arafat: Controlled and ordered by the PLO leadership in exile from Tunisia.

Teacher Guidance: Task: Where on the scale do you place the uprising, and what is your single piece of historical evidence justifying why the PLO in Tunis was caught off guard?

Pupil Response:

L3: KT 3.3: Attempts at a Solution: From the Oslo Accords to Oslo II, 1988–1995

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of Arafat's renunciation of terrorism in a speech at the UN (1988).
- ☐ Analyze changing superpower policies in the Middle East: US involvement in the Gulf War (1991), and the end of the Cold War.
- ☐ Evaluate Arafat, Rabin and the Oslo Accords (1993); the setting up of the Palestinian National Authority; the Israel-Jordan peace treaty (1994); and Oslo II (1995).

Q1. Why did the visual handshake between Rabin and Arafat symbolize an astonishing diplomatic breakthrough, and what major obstacles remained unresolved?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which Israeli Defence Minister orchestrated the June 1982 invasion of Lebanon?

What was the official Israeli codename for the June 1982 invasion of Lebanon?

What notorious massacre of Palestinian civilians took place in Beirut in September 1982 by Christian Phalangist militias?

To which North African capital was Yasser Arafat and the PLO leadership evacuated in August 1982?

What Arabic term meaning 'shaking off' refers to the spontaneous grassroots Palestinian uprising that broke out in December 1987?

In which dense refugee camp in the Gaza Strip did the First Intifada begin following a fatal road collision?

What primary weapon used by Palestinian youths against Israeli soldiers captured global television headlines?

What Islamic resistance organisation was founded in December 1987 in Gaza as a militant rival to the secular PLO?

What historic concession did Yasser Arafat announce in a speech to the UN in Geneva in December 1988?

What official Israeli commission of inquiry found Ariel Sharon personally responsible for failing to prevent the Sabra and Shatila massacres?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **UNLU**

Q2. How did Yasser Arafat enact a historic shift in PLO strategy in late 1988?

Q3. How did the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991 severely damage the PLO's geopolitical position?

Q4. Why was the PLO left bankrupt and diplomatically isolated following the 1991 Gulf War?

Q5. What convinced Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin to engage in secret negotiations with the PLO in 1993?

Q6. Source Detective: Study the distribution of Areas A, B, and C. Why did this fragmented "archipelago" of isolated Palestinian urban enclaves lead many Palestinians to view Oslo II as an unworkable compromise?

Q7. Why did the Oslo II Accords trigger a massive political backlash among Palestinians?

Q8. What event dealt a fatal blow to the peace process on 4 November 1995?

Q9. Explain how Yasser Arafat's 1988 Geneva speech helped open the path towards the 1993 Oslo Accords.

Q10. Explain why the Oslo Accords deferred the most difficult 'permanent status' issues, and what problems this caused.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q11. Why did leaders who compromised for peace—such as Yitzhak Rabin and Anwar Sadat—face extreme danger from extremists on their own side?

***Guidance:** Both leaders were assassinated not by their foreign adversaries, but by religious and political extremists from their own people who viewed territorial concessions as treason.*

- SENTENCE STARTERS:**
- *Peacemakers like Rabin and Sadat faced assassination because...*
 - *Extremists on their own side opposed compromise because...*

Pupil Response:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q12. Explain the importance of the Oslo I Accord (1993) for attempts to achieve peace in the Middle East.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 'X LINKED TO Y' SIGNIFICANCE FRAMEWORK (2 FOCUSED PEEL PARAGRAPHS)

EDEXCEL
PAPER 2

Write exactly 2 analytical PEEL paragraphs (approx. 10–12 minutes). Divide your analysis into (1) Immediate / Short-Term Importance and (2) Long-Term / Strategic Significance. Always explain the difference the Oslo I Accord (Declaration of Principles, 1993) made for the Israeli-Palestinian peace process.

[P1] Immediate / Short-Term Importance: Explain how Oslo I broke the 45-year existential deadlock through historic mutual recognition between Israel and the PLO and the creation of the Palestinian Authority.

[P2] Long-Term / Strategic Transformation: Explain how the deferral of permanent status issues (Jerusalem, refugees, borders, settlements) enabled extremist sabotage, culminating in the assassination of Yitzhak Rabin in 1995.

Sentence Starters:

- "In the short term, the Oslo I Accord of September 1993 was of revolutionary importance because it achieved historic mutual recognition between the State of Israel and the Palestine Liberation Organization, breaking a 45-year existential deadlock."
- "This was demonstrated by the iconic handshake between Yitzhak Rabin and Yasser Arafat on the White House lawn, followed by the establishment of the Palestinian National Authority (PNA) to govern Gaza and Jericho."
- "In the long term, however, Oslo's deliberate decision to postpone permanent status issues—namely the sovereignty of Jerusalem, the right of return for refugees, and Jewish settlement expansion—fatally undermined the peace process."

Causal Connectives: In the short term, the Oslo I Accord (Declaration of Principles, 1993) was of decisive importance for the Israeli-Palestinian peace process because • This was demonstrated when • In the long term, this fundamentally altered • Crucially, the strategic impact was that • Ultimately, the significance of the Oslo I Accord (Declaration of Principles, 1993) for the Israeli-Palestinian peace process was that

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EXIT TICKET • SPLIT-PERSPECTIVE HEADLINES

Write two **6-word newspaper headlines** capturing the historic handshake between Yitzhak Rabin and Yasser Arafat on the White House lawn (13 September 1993):

- **Headline A (Optimistic Global View - The New York Times):** Celebrating historic mutual recognition and hope for peace.
- **Headline B (Skeptical / Militant View - Hamas or Right-Wing Israeli Settler):** Condemning the accords as a fatal betrayal.

Teacher Guidance: Strict constraint: Exactly 6 words per headline!

Pupil Response:

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East (1945–1995)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)

GCSE Exam Practice: Question Bank

Choose an exam question from the bank below and answer it on the blank lined pages that follow.

From KT 3.1: Diplomatic Negotiations: From Shuttle Diplomacy to Camp David, 1974–1979

1. Explain one consequence of the 1979 Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty (Treaty of Washington) for Egypt's position in the Arab world.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

From KT 3.2: The Palestinian Issue: Lebanon, Sabra & Shatila, and the First Intifada, 1974–1993

1. Write a narrative account analysing the escalation of the Israeli-Palestinian conflict in the years 1982–1988. You may use the following in your answer: • Operation Peace for Galilee and the siege of Beirut (1982) • The outbreak of the First Intifada in Gaza (1987) You must also use information of your own.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

From KT 3.3: Attempts at a Solution: From the Oslo Accords to Oslo II, 1988–1995

1. Explain the importance of the Oslo I Accord (1993) for attempts to achieve peace in the Middle East.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

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